



The Genzmer report

Original text (in German) of the report on the 1764 tornado in Woldeck by Gottlob Burchard Genzmer. <https://digit.in/jan20-19>



Weird weather

All the strangest weather events in one place, including a tornado filled with bugs, or the bugnado. <https://digit.in/jan20-20>

CRAZY NADOS

The high velocity winds associated with tornadoes can create some pretty spectacular weather events, and no we are not just talking about a rain of sea creatures.

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ornadoes are a staple of sci-fi thriller movies, with the most famous being the Sharknado series,

where a waterspout lifts sharks from the ocean and moves them to cities. These movies are typically low budget, and are either intentionally or unintentionally comedic. The formula is simple, make a tornado worse by making it strike another dangerous thing. Metal tornado had a twister with a magnetic anomaly, that could say eat up a passing motorcyclist. Stonado is like Sharknado, but with stones instead of the much cooler sharks. In Atomic Twister, predictably the tornado strikes a nuclear reactor. In Devil Winds, a tornado looms over a research facility, threatening to cause a release of hazardous biochemicals. All of these movies beg the question, how dangerous and freaky are these tornadoes really? The answer is

surprisingly, quite a bit. Really strange things can happen in the most devastating tornadoes.

NADO CLASSIFICATION

Tornadoes are classified into types based on the conditions of their formation. Tornadoes mostly originate from a particular type of thunderstorm known as supercells, and are seen in only some parts of the world. Most frequently these storms occur in North America, Southern Africa, Australia and some parts of Europe. Only a few places in east India have tornadoes. Now nados are classified by type and category. A single tornado can have multiple vortices, where they all move around a central point. Additionally, a large tornado may have in its orbit a smaller satellite tornado. Waterspouts are tornadoes that move over water. Now, there are also some relatively calm tornadoes that form in fair weather conditions, from cumulus clouds. At sea, these are called fair

weather waterspouts, and on land, they are called landspouts. In conditions of strong lateral winds, gustnadoes can form, and scientists are unsure whether to classify them as tornadoes or not. They are even weaker than landspouts. Dust devils are whirlwinds of dust, and are also calmer than the weakest tornadoes. In cases of wildfires with intense heat, fire whirls, or fire infused tornadoes can form, which can on rare occasions connect with storm systems above. These are also not as strong as the tornadoes originating in supercells. Finally, rotating updrafts meeting steam exhausts from power plants and lead to the formation of steam devils. These are the rarest of tornado like phenomena, and can also be formed naturally over hot springs.

Then come the categories of the tornado, which is based on the Fujita Scale introduced in 1971 by Ted Fujita. The current implementation of the scale is known as the Enhanced Fujita